

Word family: **glide / glides / glided / gliding / glider**

Base word: glide

Past tense: glided

Past participle: glided

ing form: gliding

Related form: glider

Part of speech: verb (動詞) / noun (名詞)

Your sentence:

> “Instead, it **glided** through the water as if it had all the time in the world.”

Meaning in this passage

Here, **glide** means to **move smoothly, quietly, and continuously with very little visible effort**.

The turtle moved through the water in a calm, effortless-looking way.

繁體中文： **平穩、流暢而幾乎不費力地移動；滑行**

中文翻譯：

> “It **glided** through the water...”

「牠在水中**平穩流暢地滑行**.....」

Here:

glide through the water = 在水中安靜、平順、幾乎不費力地移動

1. **glide = move smoothly and continuously (移動) — 滑行；平穩移動**

This is the meaning used in your passage.

Meaning: To move smoothly, quietly, and continuously, usually with little visible effort.

Practice 1 — Original

> “The sea turtle **glided** through the water.”

「海龜在水中**平穩地滑行**。」

Practice 2

> “The swan **glided** across the lake.”

「天鵝在湖面上**優雅地滑行**。」

Practice 3

> “She **glided** across the dance floor.”

「她在舞池上**輕盈流暢地移動**。」

glide = 動作平順、連續、安靜，看起來幾乎不需要太多力氣

Common:

- * glide through water
- * glide across ice
- * glide across the floor
- * glide silently

These belong to one broad **smooth movement** sense.

2. **glide = fly without engine power (飛行) — 滑翔**

A bird or aircraft can **glide** by moving through the air without active propulsion.

Practice 4

> “The eagle **glided** above the valley.”

「老鷹在山谷上空**滑翔**。」

Practice 5

> “The aircraft **glided** safely toward the runway.”

「飛機**滑翔**着安全接近跑道。」

glide = 不靠持續推進力，而利用氣流、速度或升力平穩飛行

This is a very established physical subtype.

For strict core counting, I would merge it with Meaning 1 under the broader idea:

> **smooth movement with little active effort**

but show it explicitly because the Chinese naturally becomes **滑翔**.

3. **glide = move easily from one state/topic/activity to another (比喻) — 順暢轉換；自然進入**

Glide can figuratively describe a smooth, effortless transition.

Practice 6

> “The conversation **glided** from one topic to another.”

「談話很自然地從一個話題**轉到**另一個話題。」

Practice 7

> “She **glided** effortlessly into her new role.”

「她很順利自然地**融入 / 進入**新的角色。」

glide = 某種狀態、話題或活動平順地轉移到另一個，不顯突兀或困難

This is a figurative extension of the smooth-motion sense.

4. **glide = pass smoothly over a surface (物件) — 滑過；掠過**

An object or body part can **glide over/across** a surface.

Practice 8

> “The brush **glided** across the paper.”

「畫筆在紙上**順滑地移過**。」

Practice 9

> “Her fingers **glided** over the keys.”

「她的手指在琴鍵上**流暢地移動**。」

Again, the underlying concept is still smooth movement, so I would not create a separate core

meaning.

5. **glide** = type of smooth speech-sound transition (語音學) — 滑音

As a noun in phonetics/music-related contexts, **glide** can refer to a smooth movement from one sound or pitch toward another.

Practice 10

> “The vowel ends with a slight **glide**.”

「這個元音結尾帶有輕微的**滑音**。」

Practice 11

> “The singer used a smooth **glide** between the two notes.”

「歌手在兩個音之間用了平滑的**滑音**。」

glide = 聲音或音高由一個位置平滑過渡到另一個位置

This is a legitimate domain-specific noun sense, though lower priority for general learners.

6. **glide** = a smooth movement (名詞) — 滑行；滑動

As a noun, **a glide** can mean a smooth continuous movement.

Practice 12

> “The bird descended in a long **glide**.”

「那隻鳥以長距離**滑翔**下降。」

Practice 13

> “The skater moved forward in a smooth **glide**.”

「溜冰者以流暢的**滑行**向前移動。」

a glide = 一次平穩、連續而流暢的滑行 / 滑翔動作

For core counting, this belongs with the main verb sense.

Related form: **gliding**

Gliding can mean the activity of flying in a glider.

Practice 14

> “He learned **gliding** during the summer.”

「他在夏天學習**滑翔飛行**。」

It can also simply be the -ing form:

> “The turtle was gliding through the water.”

Related form: **glider**

A **glider** is an aircraft designed to fly without an engine providing continuous thrust.

Practice 15

> “The **glider** circled above the hills.”

「那架**滑翔機**在山丘上空盤旋。」

Practice 16

> “She learned to fly a **glider**.”

「她學會駕駛**滑翔機**。」

glider = 主要靠氣流和升力滑翔飛行的無持續動力飛行器

The word can also refer to some animals or objects that glide, but the aircraft meaning is the most useful general sense.

Important distinction: **glide** vs **slide**

glide

emphasizes:

- * smoothness
- * grace
- * continuous effortless-looking movement

slide

means move along a surface while remaining in contact with it.

> “The swan glided across the lake.”

smooth/elegant.

> “The box slid across the floor.”

surface movement.

So:

glide = 平穩流暢地滑行

slide = 沿表面滑動

Important distinction: **glide vs coast**

You already mapped **coast**.

glide

focuses on **smooth, graceful movement**.

coast

focuses on moving **with little active power**, often because momentum or gravity carries you.

A bicycle can:

> coast downhill

A turtle can:

> glide through water

There is overlap, but the emphasis differs.

Important distinction: **glide vs drift**

glide

suggests smooth and often controlled movement.

drift

suggests being carried by wind/current or moving without much control.

> glide through the water

> drift with the current

So the turtle **glided**, which makes it sound controlled and graceful rather than passive.

Important distinction: **glide vs float**

float

means remain supported on or in a fluid without sinking.

glide

means actively or continuously move smoothly through it.

> "The leaf floated on the water."

> "The turtle glided through the water."

Different focus.

Important distinction: **glide vs swim**

swim

is the broad verb for moving through water.

glide

describes **how** that movement looks:

> smooth, quiet, effortless.

So the turtle was technically:

> swimming

but stylistically:

> gliding

This is exactly why **glide** creates a more graceful image in your passage.

Family-extension note

The practical modern family includes:

* **glide**

* **glided**

* **gliding**

* **glider**

Useful constructions include:

* glide through water

* glide across ice

* glide through the air

* glide from one topic to another

* glider aircraft

The Golden Manual says figurative uses and domain extensions should be checked, but uses sharing the same underlying mental image should remain grouped rather than artificially multiplied.

Master comparison

Form / sense	MCQ-ready Traditional Chinese meaning
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glide — smooth movement	平穩、流暢、安靜而幾乎不費力地連續移動
glide — flight	不靠持續推進力而利用氣流、速度或升力滑翔；屬於 smooth-movement 義
glide — figurative transition	從一個話題、狀態或活動自然、順暢地轉到另一個
a glide	一次流暢的滑行 / 滑翔動作

glide — phonetic/musical	聲音或音高由一個位置平滑過渡到另一個；滑音	
gliding	滑翔飛行活動，亦為 glide 的 -ing 形式	
glider	主要依靠氣流和升力飛行的滑翔機	

For your original sentence

> “Instead, it **glided** through the water as if it had all the time in the world.”

The exact meaning is:

glide = 在水中平穩、安靜、優雅而幾乎毫不費力地移動

So:

> **glided through the water**

= **在水中流暢優雅地滑行**

The word choice is stronger than simply **swam**, because it adds the image of:

> smoothness + calmness + grace + apparent effortlessness

For your database, I would count **2 genuinely useful core meanings** for **glide**:

1. **move smoothly and continuously with little apparent effort**
2. **figuratively move or transition smoothly from one state/topic/activity to another**

I would keep **aircraft/bird gliding** under #1, treat the phonetic/music noun **glide** as a lower-priority domain extension, and keep **glider** as a family form rather than inflate the main count.